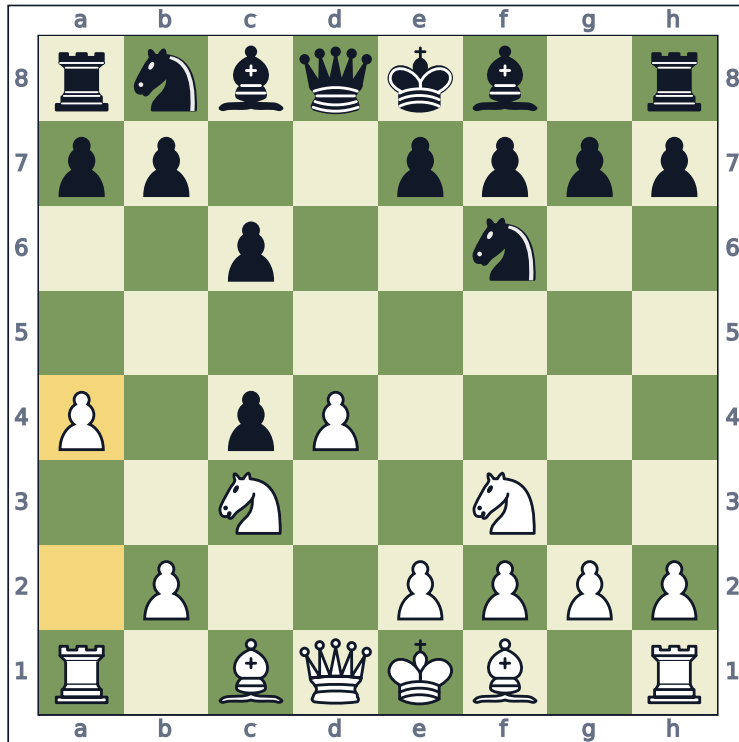


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Slav Defense

ECO D16 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.51 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D16 covers Slav Defense. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Slav Defense: Alapin Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Black is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: Black pawn on c4, Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D16 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to D16 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Slav Defense: Alapin Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4

002 Slav Defense: Smyslov Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Na6

003 Slav Defense: Soultanbeieff Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 e6

004 Slav Defense: Steiner Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bg4